MARYLEBONE ROSTER · LINKS DESIGNER · THE SHORTLIST AT A GLANCE

The shortlist at a glance

Balanced V6, Level Crossing and Middle Ground beside today's link, for the new CEA link from January 2027

Prepared 9 November 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas · per person, a year, cover weeks aside

Whichever is chosen the same on all three, against today

✓ BETTER THAN TODAY

- **9 of 9** December staffing rules met — today 4 of 9
- **8h 10m** longest weekday closing shift — today 8h 40m
- **5** days in a row at most, set duties — today 7
- **3** on the floor at all times — today 2
- **0** fatigue warnings, set duties — today 4

= AS TODAY

- **30** days off for 14 days' leave — as today
- **14** days' leave for four weeks off — as today
- **35h** week, 218.6 days a year — today 219.0

▲ WORSE THAN TODAY

- **28** Saturdays at work — today 26
- **94** finishes at 22:00 or later — today 78
- **42** finishes at 23:00 or later — today 39

Where they differ today for scale; each design against today

✓ better than today ▲ worse than today **Bold** the clear best of the three

Each person, a year	Today 20 lines	Balanced V6 MB-26-V6	Level Crossing LC-26-T10	Middle Ground MG-26-T8
Leave and time off				
Days off that 14 days' leave buys, at worst	19	19	19	✓ **20**
Rostered Sundays inside the 30 days off	2	✓ **1**	2	2
Full weekends off, a year	10	✓ 12	✓ 14	✓ 14
Breaks of three days or more, a year	13	▲ **6**	▲ 2	▲ 4
Single rest days, a year	10	▲ 22	**10**	▲ 12
Shortest rest between shifts	12h 30m	✓ 14h 20m	✓ 14h 20m	✓ **14h 35m**
Your shifts				
Weeks on one shift time, Monday to Friday	7 of 16	▲ 7 of 21	✓ 18 of 21	✓ 18 of 21
Change of start time, week to week	4h 00m	▲ 4h 08m	✓ **1h 34m**	✓ 1h 42m
Weeks in a row of earlies, or of lates	2, up to 3	▲ **3, up to 5**	▲ 5, up to 7	▲ 5, up to 7
Starts at 06:20, a year (a matter of taste)	62	50	58	48
Earlies finishing before 14:00, a year	26	▲ 20	▲ 20	▲ 12
Longest shift	9h 10m	✓ 9h 00m	✓ 9h 00m	✓ **8h 30m**
Longest Saturday closing shift	9h 10m	✓ 8h 55m	✓ 8h 40m	✓ **8h 10m**
Heaviest week, Monday to Saturday	43h 50m	✓ 42h 55m	✓ 42h 30m	✓ 42h 30m
If a cover week falls badly				
Most days at work in a row	9	▲ 10	✓ **6**	✓ 7
Fatigue warnings	5	✓ 4	✓ **none**	✓ 1
55 hours or more in seven days	never	▲ 58h 35m	**never**	▲ 57h 00m
Trains and pay				
Fit to the trains, weekday · Sat · Sun (0 exact)	52.0 · 65.9 · 70.2	✓ 40.0 · 17.3 · 29.2	✓ 31.4 · 17.6 · 29.2	✓ 32.7 · 9.8 · 28.6
Pay for your share of Sundays, against today	—	▲ about £200 less	▲ about £200 less	▲ about £350 less
Pay with no overtime at all, against today	—	✓ about £140 more	✓ about £130 more	✓ about £90 more

Each one's edge, and its cost

Balanced V6 MB-26-V6 · 1818a1c2

- ✓ **The shortest runs of earlies or lates, the most long breaks, and the fewest Sundays inside its 30 days off.**
- ▲ One shift time in 7 weeks of 21; 22 single rest days a year; up to 10 days in a row if a cover week falls badly.

Level Crossing LC-26-T10 · 32241e32

- ✓ **No fatigue warning and no 55-hour week in any cover-week placement tested, and the steadiest start times.**
- ▲ The fewest breaks of three days or more, 2 a year, against 6 and 4.

Middle Ground MG-26-T8 · 20668ac9

- ✓ **No shift over 8h 30m, the closest Saturday fit, and the best worst case for leave.**
- ▲ The fewest earlies finishing before 14:00, 12 a year; the shortest Sundays, so the least Sunday pay.

How it is counted. Over 52 weeks: two turns of a 26-week link, today's 20-week link scaled to match. A working day Monday to Saturday costs a day's leave; a rest day or a Sunday none, as Sunday is overtime, so a rostered Sunday inside your leave is overtime not worked.

"Up to" and "if a cover week falls badly": the worst place a cover week's four duties could fall. Pay is gross, at the CEA rate of £21.49, with no other overtime; the app's Pay Calculator estimates a payslip. Fatigue warnings follow the ORR's good-practice list, never pass or fail. More: the shortlist sheet, What it means if you… and each proposal sheet.